

Coach, Therapist, *or Both?*

A two-minute check to help you decide where to start.

A coach is the right partner for building skills and making decisions. A therapist is the right partner for safety and for healing old wounds. Many people do both. Tick everything that sounds like you right now.

List A

- ☐ I want to make a decision about my work or my life.
- ☐ I want to change how I work, not just how I feel about it.
- ☐ I keep saying yes when I mean no.
- ☐ I am functioning day to day, but I feel stuck.
- ☐ I want a plan, practice, and someone to hold me to it.
- ☐ I am mostly focused on what comes next.

List B

- ☐ My mood is low most days.
- ☐ I have lost interest in things I used to enjoy.
- ☐ My sleep or appetite has changed.
- ☐ I feel hopeless about things getting better.
- ☐ Something from my past keeps getting in the way now.
- ☐ A relationship in my life feels unsafe, not just frustrating.

What your ticks mean

Mostly List A, nothing in List B. Coaching is a good place to start.

Anything in List B. Start with your doctor or a licensed therapist. A coach is not a substitute for mental health care.

Some of both. Many people work with a therapist and a coach at the same time. Start with the therapist, and add coaching when you are ready to focus on decisions and next steps.

IF YOU ARE IN CRISIS

If you are having thoughts of harming yourself, call or text 988 to reach the 988 Suicide and Crisis Lifeline (US), or call 911.

Write down where you are starting

Where I am starting: coach, therapist, or both?

The one thing I most want to be different in three months:

The first step I will take this week:

This check is general information, not a diagnosis or medical advice. If you are unsure, talk to your doctor.



Lauren Fine, MD

Lauren Fine is a coach, TEDx speaker, and story strategist helping people at every inflection point identify, shape, and tell the story of who they're becoming. She is a physician, medical educator, Harvard Macy Institute faculty, and the founder of ReasonDx.

Make Room For It

A free Facebook group for high achievers making room for what matters.

facebook.com/groups/permissiontochange

A free 55-minute session

Think it through with me. Leave with your next step. No sales pitch.

laurenfine.com/free-session